

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 850

By Martin B

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the Huntingdon High School football team, TSSAA Division I, Class 2A state champion.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to specially honor and commend those successful high school teams that, through their magnificent exploits, bring honor to Tennessee and serve as exceptional ambassadors for this State; and

WHEREAS, the Huntingdon High School football team achieved an extraordinary level of success during the 2025 season, winning the coveted Tennessee Secondary School Athletic Association (TSSAA) Division I, Class 2A State Football Championship; and

WHEREAS, the Huntingdon Mustangs claimed the title of state champion by defeating reigning state champions Marion County High School by a score of 20-7 in the championship game on December 6, 2025, at Finley Stadium in Chattanooga; and

WHEREAS, on their path to the championship game, the Mustangs defeated Milan High School 35-34, East Robertson High School 40-20, Lewis County High School 49-22, and Memphis Business Academy 22-12, finishing the season with a 14-1 record; and

WHEREAS, in addition to claiming victory over reigning state champion Marion County, the Mustangs defeated four region champions in the playoffs, beating teams with three Mr. Football finalists, the 2025 Mr. Football, and last year's Mr. Football; and

WHEREAS, the Mustangs posted three shutouts for the year and held seven of fifteen opponents to seven points or less, even after being picked to finish fifth in the region by one preseason publication; and

WHEREAS, the members of this exceptional championship team are Tyreke Hutch, Owen King, Zayden Connelly, Hayes Eubanks, Taylor Jones, Ayden Woods, Braylin Dearmon, Lucas Smith, Gavin Gray, Keimonte Strayhorn, Jeramyah Cannon, Maddox Holmes, Benton

Norman, Colt Wood, Brennan Meggs, Kenton Smith, Kylen Turner, Montrae Leyhew, Myles Pelonero, K'Shun Carter, Kingston Smith, Garvin Kee, Ayden King, Broox Bennett, Haven Dillahunty, Nick Smith, Silas Sharp, D.J. Armour, Phoenix Barnhill, Brayden Davis, Kaden King, Taylin Strayhorn, Bryson Whiteside, Grant Wilson, Elijah Hays, Kyle Byrd, Riley Ford, Ashtyn Donald, Greyson Anderson, Jayden Gordon, and Ethan Raffield; and

WHEREAS, the 2025 Huntingdon Mustangs enjoyed the services of an outstanding coaching staff led by Head Coach Eric Swenson, Assistant Head Coach Robbie Miller, and assistant coaches Adam Parish, Bryan Dickens, Ben Carter, Trevor Burlison, and Rick Wallace; and

WHEREAS, state championships are achieved only through hard work, dedication, and the ability to work together as a team and excel with a cooperative spirit; the Mustangs exhibited each of these rare qualities during their championship season; and

WHEREAS, the football players of Huntingdon High School epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved the highest level of success on the field while showing the highest degree of character both on and off the gridiron; they inspired their fellow students and united the entire community during their triumphant run through the 2025 season; and

WHEREAS, the dedication, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young men not only made possible a championship football season, but also surely bode well for their success in every future endeavor; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the football players of Huntingdon High School for serving as exemplars of the high quality of the youth of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE

CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the players, coaching staff, team support staff, administrators, cheerleaders, and fans of the Huntingdon High School football team on winning the 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class 2A State Football Championship.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.